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Senior Service Designer (Ref: 18831)

Ministry of Justice

Apply before 11:55 pm on Thursday 2nd July 2026

Ministry of
JUSTICE

Reference number

467220

Salary

£58,511 - £70,725

The national salary range is £58,511 - £65,329, London salary range is £63,343 - £70,725 Your salary will be dependent on your base location
National: £58,511- £73,450 (which may include an allowance up to £14,939)
London: £63,343 -£78,225 (which may include an allowance up to £14,882)

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Grade 7

Contract type

Fixed term

Length of employment

For a period of up to 18 months

Type of role

Digital

Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Part-time

Number of jobs available

4

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Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, Scotland, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This position is based Nationally

Job description

Senior Service Designer (Prison Based)

Closing Date: 02/07/26

Interviews: 20/07/2026

Grade: 7

(MoJ candidates who are on a specialist grade, will be able to retain this grade on lateral transfer)

Salary**

National: £58,511- £73,450 (which may include an allowance up to £14,939)

London: £63,343 -£78,225 (which may include an allowance up to £14,882)

Working pattern: Full-time, Part-time, Flexible working,

Location:

HMP Bullingdon (Bicester)

HMP Durham

HMP Exeter

HMP Pentonville (London)

Contract Type: 18-month FTC with the potential for the role to become permanent (subject to review)

Number of vacancies: 4

Vacancy number:

Minimum 4 days per week in the prison

***Please indicate which Prison location you are applying for in your application**

The Role

Please note this role requires you to pass BPSS and a Enhanced DBS check
Please click on the [link](#) for details.

We re recruiting four **Senior Service Designers** here at [Justice Digital, Data and Science](#) to be part of our warm and collaborative Prisons Digital team.

This role aligns against [Senior Service Designer](#) from the Government Digital and Data Framework

We re looking for four Senior Service Designers to join the senior leadership teams, onsite, in 4 Reception prisons: HMP Bullingdon (near Bicester), HMP Durham, HMP Exeter and HMP Pentonville (London). This initiative follows a successful pilot where an embedded service designer was able to design and implement effective operational change.

You will be trained to carry keys and move independently around residential wings and other areas of the prison. Working alongside Governors and senior leaders across reducing reoffending, security, regime and operations, you will identify and test opportunities to improve how prisons function day to day.

You will conduct research with staff and people in prison, turn findings into actionable insights, and work with staff to design, prototype and test improvements to services, processes and operational practices. You will communicate insights and recommendations to stakeholders at all levels and help shape decisions about which changes to implement and scale.

You will also help introduce and embed user-centred design approaches in an environment where many staff will have little or no experience of these methods. This includes coaching others to participate in research and design activities and demonstrating how user-centred approaches can help solve persistent operational problems and improve outcomes for people in prison.

Alongside your local prison role, you will be part of a national programme focused on improving the role of reception prisons and outcomes for prisoners. You will work with other practitioners to share learning, coordinate approaches and scale successful changes across the prison estate.

You will also be part of the Prisons Digital service design team, giving you access to collaboration, professional support and strategic context on wider digital change across HMPPS. Beyond this, you will be connected to the wider Ministry of Justice user-centred design community, working alongside researchers, designers, analysts and others improving services across the justice system.

We're committed to creating a positive work environment, as well as doing great work. We offer brilliant training opportunities, excellent kit and support from expert colleagues. On top of that, you'll find flexible working, an inclusive culture and a place where your opinion is valued.

Please note that these are onsite roles, in category B local prisons for adult males. They are all reception prisons, meaning they are the entry point for people into the prison estate. The role will include direct contact with people who have been charged with or convicted of a broad range of offences, including violent and sexual offences.

If you're passionate about creating positive change and are excited to work in an environment that's equal parts rewarding and challenging, we would love to hear from you!

You'll receive a range of excellent benefits when you join our department, including:

A generous employer pension contribution of 28.97% through the [Civil Service Pension Scheme](#).

25 days of annual leave, (increasing to 30 days once you have reached 5 years of service), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King's birthday.

Flexible working arrangements including hybrid working, working part time or compressed hours. Designed to support a positive work-life balance.

Employees are allocated **10% of their working time for personal and professional development**.

A £1k per person learning budget is in place to support all our people, with access to best-in-class conferences and seminars, accreditation with professional bodies, fully funded vocational programmes and e-learning platforms.

Compassionate maternity, adoption, and shared parental leave policies, with up to 26 weeks leave at full pay, 13 weeks with partial pay, and 13 weeks further leave. And maternity support/paternity leave at full pay for 2 weeks, too!

You can find more details of the Benefits we offer [here](#). To help picture your life at [MoJ Justice Digital, Data and Science](#) please take a look at our [blog](#).

Key Responsibilities:

Conduct research with prison staff and people in prison to understand needs, challenges and opportunities for improvement across the prison system

Synthesise research findings into actionable insights and communicate them clearly to stakeholders at all levels

Lead the design, prototyping and testing of improvements to prison services, processes and day-to-day operations

Work closely with prison leadership teams and frontline staff to identify priorities, shape strategic decisions and support implementation of change

Develop service concepts and blueprints that consider the wider operational, policy, digital and non-digital prison ecosystem

Advocate for and apply user-centred design methods in environments where these approaches may be unfamiliar

Coach and support prison staff and colleagues to participate in research and design activities

Contribute to the national programme of improvement across reception prisons by collaborating with other practitioners, sharing learning, and supporting the scaling of effective approaches across the prison estate

Collaborate with colleagues across Prisons Digital and the wider Ministry of Justice user-centred design community to share learning, shape wider change and support the development and scaling of digital and non-digital solutions

If this feels like an exciting challenge, something you are enthusiastic about, and want to join our team please read on and apply!

Person Specification

Essential

Evidence-based design - experience conducting and synthesising research in complex environments to identify actionable insights and inform service improvements.

Designing strategically - experience designing or improving end-to-end services in complex operational or public sector environments.

Design communication - ability to communicate complex insights and design ideas clearly to a wide range of stakeholders and build support for change.

Iterative design - experience designing, prototyping and testing service improvements using appropriate design methods and artefacts.

Designing together - experience working collaboratively with multidisciplinary teams and involving users and stakeholders throughout the design process.

Leading design - experience influencing stakeholders, setting direction, coaching others and embedding user-centred design approaches in environments where these methods may be unfamiliar.

Designing for everyone - experience designing inclusive and ethical services for people with complex needs or who may experience disadvantage, vulnerability or exclusion.

Willingness to be assessed against [the requirements](#) for BPSS and Enhanced DBS clearance

We welcome the unique contribution diverse applicants bring and do not discriminate based on culture, ethnicity, race, nationality or national origin, age, sex, gender identity or expression, religion or belief, disability status, sexual orientation, educational or social background or any other factor.

Our values are Purpose, Humanity Openness and Together. Find out more [here](#) about how we celebrate diversity and an inclusive culture in our workplace.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) and the [Civil Service D&I Strategy](#).

Salary Information**

Base salary for this role is from **National: £58,511- £73,450 London: £63,343 -£78,225**

New entrants to the Civil Service joining the MoJ are expected to start at the minimum of the pay band.

Existing Civil Servants moving on a level transfer will retain their current base salary or move to the minimum of the pay band for the role, whichever is higher.

Existing Civil Servants who are promoted will either move to the bottom of the new grade's pay band or receive a 10% uplift, whichever provides the greater increase.

Candidates may also be eligible for a non-pensionable Government Digital & Data Allowance of up to £14,882 per year (London) or £14,939 (National). This is a temporary allowance, reviewed annually and may be retained, amended, or withdrawn.

The final offer will reflect the skills and experience you demonstrate during the assessment process.

Person specification

Please refer to Job Description

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £58,511, Ministry of Justice contributes £16,950 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

Access to learning and development

A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance

A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity

A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Annual Leave

Public Holidays

Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: <https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ>

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

In Justice Digital, Data and Science, we recruit using a combination of the [Government Digital and Data Profession Capability](#) and [Success Profiles](#) Frameworks. We shall assess a combination of your Experience and Behaviours during the assessment process.

Stage 1 - Application and sift:

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application

A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Person Specification of this advert.

A **Personal Statement** (no more than 750 words) which should outline your experience and skills, giving clear examples of work undertaken. It should specifically address the following two criteria listed below, using a separate paragraph for each.

Evidence-based design - experience conducting and synthesising research in complex environments to identify actionable insights and inform service improvements.

Designing for everyone - experience designing inclusive and ethical services for people with complex needs or who may experience disadvantage, vulnerability or exclusion.

***Please indicate which Prison location you are applying for in your application**

A diverse sift panel will review the information in your CV and Personal Statement to assess the sift criteria specified above. We operate an anonymous shortlisting process. Please ensure your CV and Personal Statement do not include your name or any other identifying details.

Should we receive a high volume of applications, a pre-sift based on Evidence-based design will be conducted before the sift.

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - [Application Guidance](#)

Stage 2 - Interviews:

Successful candidates who meet the required standard will then be invited to a panel interview held via Microsoft Teams. At interview stage, you will be

assessed against the following Success Profile elements Experience and the following Behaviours:

Leadership

Communicating and influencing

Working together

As part of your interview, you will be asked to deliver a presentation that assesses your experience in Iterative design. Further details will be provided if successful at sift.

Appointments are made strictly in merit order. In the event that two or more candidates receive identical interview scores, the **[insert lead behaviour/ criteria]** will be applied as the primary lead criterion to determine the final merit order.

Should you be unsuccessful in the role that you have applied for but demonstrate the capability for a role at a lower level, we reserve the right to discuss this opportunity with you and offer you the position without needing a further application.

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months, from which further appointments may be made.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and
family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status
under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\)](#) (opens in a new
window)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and
family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application
for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement
Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who
were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who
have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements](#) (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code](#) (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of
behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in
the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles](#) (opens in a new
window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As
such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with
disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever
it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) (opens in a
new window) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy](#) (opens in
a new window).

Apply and further information

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone :	0345 241 5358
Recruitment team	
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (Moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: <http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints/>

<https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?JobId=1103>



